

Nina — Assignment 7: Visual Brand Foundation

Completed by Nina Harris | INFO7375: Branding & AI | Northeastern University Due: March 20, 2026

A Note to Students

This is my Assignment 7 submission — completed using Nina, the same tool you're about to use.

I'm sharing it for one reason: to show you what the process looks like when it's done properly. Not a filled-in template. The result of being interrogated, corrected, and made to go deeper than the comfortable answer.

A few things worth knowing:

Nina has a point of view. It makes calls on strategic questions and explains the reasoning. If you disagree, argue back with evidence — not preference. That skill is what separates top quartile work from adequate work.

Nina will not do the assignment for you. It does the assignment with you. It asks harder questions than you expected. It stays in the room until the work is right.

Include at least one moment in your submission where you disagreed with or refined a Nina recommendation. Describe what Nina suggested, why you changed it, and what your final decision was and why. This is the requirement that proves you actually did the thinking.

Good luck. Show me something that surprises me.

— Nina Harris

Adjunct Professor, Northeastern University College of Engineering
Creative and Brand Director | Co-creator, Nina AI

COMPONENT 1: CREATIVE BRIEF

Objective

Nina will establish itself in year one as the definitive brand development platform for students building personal brands for employment and nonprofits communicating their mission for funding — measured by 500 active users, 50 documented success stories, and a net promoter

score above 70 by month twelve.

Year two expands to small business owners. Not before.

Target Audience

Primary: Students and recent graduates who have built real skills and cannot articulate their value to employers in a crowded, unforgiving job market. They don't need polish. They need a point of view.

Secondary: Nonprofit leaders running under-resourced organizations whose impact exceeds their ability to communicate it to donors, funders, and the public. Eleven years of real work. No language for it yet.

The broader truth both audiences share: Nina is for anyone whose expertise doesn't live in words. Brand strategy, writing, and visual direction have always been accessible to people who could pay for them. Nina makes them accessible to everyone else.

Tertiary: Small business owners. Year two. Not before.

Key Message — UVP

Our product helps students and nonprofit leaders get hired and get funded through an AI Creative Director who finds what's broken in their brand and shows them exactly how to fix it.

UVP Development — Three Iterations

Iteration 1: "Our product helps people build better brands through AI." Problem: "People" is not an audience. "Better brands" is not an outcome. "Through AI" is not a differentiator. Could belong to fifty products.

Iteration 2: "Our product helps students and nonprofits build professional brand identities through an AI trained on 35 years of Creative Direction expertise." Better. But "professional brand identities" is a category, not an outcome. What does it actually get you?

Iteration 3 — Final: "Our product helps students and nonprofit leaders get hired and get funded through an AI Creative Director who finds what's broken in their brand and shows them exactly how to fix it." The outcomes are specific and human. The differentiator is the mechanism. The sentence is false if a competitor says it.

Support Points

Support Points

1. **35 years of Creative Direction, finally accessible.** Nina Harris trained this tool. Her instincts, her standards, her eye for what's wrong and how to fix it — embedded in a system anyone can access at midnight, in any language, at a price that has never existed for this level of expertise.
 2. **Nina speaks every language.** No human Creative Director can say that. For students and nonprofit leaders who are not native English speakers, this is the difference between having access and not having access.
 3. **The conversation is the product.** Nina doesn't hand users a template. It sees what's wrong, names it specifically, and shows how to fix it — grounded in real applications. The nav bar. The video intro. The side of the building.
 4. **Built by two people whose combined expertise doesn't exist anywhere else at this price.** Nina Harris brings 35 years of Creative and Brand Direction. Nik Bear Brown brings the AI architecture that makes her expertise scale.
 5. **Strategy through execution — in one place.** From archetype to hex code. From brand purpose to website wireframe. Complete.
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Tone & Style

Five words: Direct. Warm. Rigorous. Honest. Occasionally dry.

A sentence Nina would say: *"Here's the problem and here's why. That logo needs to work across a nav bar, a video intro, and the side of a building. Here's how I'd solve it so it's legible across all applications."*

A sentence Nina would never say: *"Great question — let's explore some options together and see what resonates!"*

Competitive Positioning

LinkedIn Learning owns breadth. Nina owns depth — one brand, built properly, with a Creative Director who stays in the room.

Canva owns the aesthetic layer. Nina owns the strategic and creative layer that makes the aesthetic layer mean something.

Career centers and nonprofit workshops own the framework handout. Nina owns the follow-through.

Fiverr owns executional talent at low prices. Nina owns Creative Direction at a price that has never existed for this level of work.

What none of them own: The experience of working with a senior Creative Director whose 35 years of expertise is embedded in every question the tool asks — in any language, at any hour, at \$19/month.

Success Metrics

1. 500 active users by month twelve — users who completed at least one full brand foundation
 2. 50 documented success stories — a student hired, a nonprofit funded, a grant won
 3. Net Promoter Score above 70 by month six
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The Single-Minded Proposition

Nina is the Creative Director who was never available to the people who needed her most — until now.

COMPONENT 2: VISUAL IDENTITY

2A — Logo Concept Directions

The Logo System Strategy

Nina's logo has two layers that work independently and together.

Layer 1 — The wordmark. "nina" in Inter Variable, lowercase. Never changes. Works at every size from favicon to billboard.

Layer 2 — The illustrated N. The N is a canvas. It changes by context, season, and story — the way Google changes its second O and MTV changed what lived on its M. The wordmark is sacred. The N is alive.

Direction 1 — The Living N

Type: Combination mark — illustrated lettermark + wordmark

Visual description: The capital N rendered as a different illustrated object in each iteration — a paper-folded construction, a sailboat, a figure mid-stride, a botanical form. The N is always recognizable as N. What it's made of changes. The wordmark "nina" sits below in Inter Variable, widely tracked, grounded and consistent.

Strategic idea: The logo is the brand philosophy made visible. The N that becomes different things — while remaining itself — is the transformation argument stated without words.

Best use case: Substack headers, LinkedIn articles, campaign materials, large-format applications. Every new N is simultaneously a logo and a content asset.

Weakness: Requires ongoing creative production. Needs clear guidelines to maintain quality across volunteer execution.

Direction 2 — The Transformation N ★ RECOMMENDED PRIMARY FIXED MARK

Type: Lettermark — single illustrated letter

Visual description: The N whose stroke becomes a butterfly wing at the apex. The vertical stroke rises, the diagonal crossbar becomes the body, the second vertical opens into wings — one wing mid-unfold, caught in the act of becoming. Drawn in a single continuous line. Precise and architectural, not decorative.

Strategic idea: Transformation is literally in the letterform. The butterfly is the brand promise made visible — the latent form always present, the transformation requiring the right conditions to emerge.

Best use case: Primary mark for NinaHarris.co, app icon, favicon, email signatures. Works as standalone icon without wordmark.

Weakness: Risks reading as personal brand rather than professional tool in some institutional contexts. Mitigated by precise, architectural execution.

Direction 3 — The Wordmark

Type: Wordmark

Visual description: "nina" in Inter Variable weight 300–400, lowercase. A single short horizontal stroke above the first "i" — a macron, not a dot — signals the name is specific and intentional. Below: "AI Brand Coach" in Inter Variable weight 400, widely tracked, Nina Slate (■ #73838A).

Strategic idea: The name is the brand. A wordmark that reads as signature — personal, specific, authored — signals that a real person stands behind this tool.

Best use case: Most versatile direction. Works at every size, every color, every context. The institutional choice for Northeastern materials, press, and academic presentations.

Weakness: Least distinctive without supporting mark. Relies on typographic precision and context.

Direction 4 — The Paper N

Type: Combination mark — geometric lettermark + wordmark

Visual description: The N constructed entirely from folded paper geometry — visible fold lines, layered planes, the architecture of origami made into a letterform. Color: Nina Cerulean

 #007E95 dominant plane, Nina Night  #002433 shadow planes, Dutch White  #F5E3C1 light-catch edges.

Strategic idea: The visual metaphor — paper construction mid-build — becomes the mark. The N is being built as you look at it. The process is present in the final form.

Best use case: App icon, favicon, digital interfaces. Strong at small sizes because geometric construction reads as intentional even when fold detail is lost.

Weakness: Requires precise execution — either a skilled designer or Adobe Firefly with detailed prompting. Canva AI will struggle with this direction.

Logo Recommendation

Direction 1 — The Living N — as the primary system, with Direction 2 — The Transformation N — as the primary fixed mark.

The Living N is the long-term brand strategy. The Transformation N is its fixed home — the mark that appears on the website, app icon, and favicon, establishing what the N means before the variations begin.

Year one execution:

- Fixed mark: Direction 2 — Transformation N
- Wordmark: Direction 3 — "nina" with descriptor
- Living N launch illustration: Direction 4 — Paper N

AI Generation Prompts

Direction 1 — Paper N (Canva AI): "Letter N made of folded origami paper, geometric and precise, teal and navy color scheme, architectural paper construction, clean white background, three-dimensional letterform, modern brand logo style."

Direction 2 — Transformation N (Canva AI): "Letter N with butterfly wings integrated into the letterform, single line drawing, minimalist, black ink on white, architectural not decorative, logo design, continuous line art."

Direction 3 — Wordmark (Canva AI): "Lowercase wordmark 'nina', clean sans-serif, slightly handwritten quality, minimalist logo, light weight letterforms, white background, personal brand signature style."

Direction 4 — Paper N (Adobe Firefly): "Capital letter N constructed from layered geometric paper planes. Each stroke is a distinct folded plane with visible crease lines. Dominant plane teal (#007E95), shadow planes dark navy (#002433), light-catch edges ivory (#F5E3C1). Modernist paper sculpture. Clean white background. No shadow except those cast by the paper planes themselves."

Iteration Documentation

Round 1 — Concept exploration Generate all four directions. Evaluate against: scalability (works at 16px favicon?), distinctiveness (false if a competitor said it?), brand alignment (expresses Sage with Caregiver edge?).

Round 2 — Direction refinement Select Transformation N and Paper N for development. Refine AI prompts. Adjust line weight, color application, and proportions in Figma or Canva.

Round 3 — System testing Apply selected direction to three applications: website header, Substack header, favicon. Does it hold at every size? Does the wordmark work independently and together with the mark?

Final selection rationale: Directions 1 + 2 as a system — the Living N makes the logo a content engine, the Transformation N gives that system a fixed emotional anchor. The wordmark completes the system for institutional contexts.

2B — Mood Board

Visual World — Three Scenes

Scene 1 — The Room That Was Designed A modern home with high ceilings and natural light from one direction. Not a showroom — a lived-in space where every object was chosen. A photograph on the wall that tells you something true about the family without a caption. Nothing is filler. Nothing is generic.

Scene 2 — The Student at Midnight A real person at a real laptop in a real space — not a WeWork, not a stock photo coffee shop. Screen glow on her face. Working on something that matters. She doesn't look like a model. She looks like Maya.

Scene 3 — The Paper Construction Mid-Build An origami or paper quilling figure caught at the moment before completion. Layers visible. Structure exposed. Something beautiful being built from raw material, one precise decision at a time.

Color System

Primary Palette

Name	Hex	Use
Nina Night	#002433	Hero backgrounds, body text on light
Nina Charcoal	#363F44	Body text, footers
Nina Slate	#43545B	Subheadings, dividers, secondary UI
Nina Cerulean	#007E95	CTAs, buttons, links

Secondary Palette

Name	Hex	Use
Nina Verdigris	#12B7BA	Highlights, illustration accents
Nina Persimmon	#E7580B	Key callouts, emphasis
Nina Dutch White	#F5E3C1	Page backgrounds, card surfaces
Nina Auburn	#A42F33	Illustration accents, error states

Accent Palette

#CE2D33

#FFAC12

#D54D04

#73838A

Illustrations and editorial content only. Not primary UI colors.

Color rationale: Nina and Humanitarians AI share a twin palette — same bones, same warmth, immediately recognizable as family. Grays and blues anchor the professional register. Teals signal accessibility and forward motion. Reds and oranges are used as accents — energy deployed deliberately, not decoratively.

Contrast Matrix — WCAG 2.1 AA

Approved combinations:

Text	Background	Ratio
Nina Night  #002433	Dutch White  #F5E3C1	~14:1 
Nina Night  #002433	White  #FFFFFF	~16:1 
Dutch White  #F5E3C1	Nina Night  #002433	~14:1 
White  #FFFFFF	Nina Cerulean  #007E95	~4.6:1 

Danger combinations — never use:

Text	Background	Issue
Nina Verdigris  #12B7BA	White  #FFFFFF	Fails AA
Orange Web  #FFAC12	White  #FFFFFF	Fails AA
Dutch White  #F5E3C1	Orange Web  #FFAC12	Fails AA

Photography overlay rule: Text over photography always requires Nina Night  #002433 at minimum 60% opacity. No exceptions.

Typography

One typeface. Inter Variable. Every weight. Every application. Download free: fonts.google.com/specimen/Inter

Role	Weight	Size	Use
Display	800	48–72px	Homepage hero

Heading 1	700	36-48px	Page titles
Heading 2	600	24-32px	Section headers
Body	400	16-18px	All reading text
Caption	500	12-14px	Labels, nav, UI
Pull Quote	300	24-28px	Testimonials

Rationale: Inter was designed for screens. It disappears into the content — the words become the hero, not the letterforms. One variable font file. Every weight. Nothing the typography asks you to notice.

Photography Direction

Real people in real moments. Not stock. Not staged to look unstaged. Natural directional light. Biographical spaces — you can tell something true about the person by looking at where they are.

What never appears: Staged keyboard hands. Performed confidence. Rented spaces. Any photograph that could have been taken by someone without a point of view.

Illustration Direction

Origami and paper quilling AI illustration style — handmade in feeling, technically impossible without AI. Used editorially — for Substack headers, LinkedIn articles, and campaign materials. Thought-provoking, idea-first, scroll-stopping.

Illustration hard nos: Flat design in blues and purples. Stock illustration. Abstract geometric shapes without narrative content. Any illustration that could appear on a competitor's site without looking wrong.

2C — Brand Style Guide Foundation

Logo Usage Rules

Sizing minimums:

• Wordmark: 120px digital, 1.5 inches print

- Wordmark: 120px digital, 1.5 inches print
- Transformation N: 32px minimum digital
- Living N illustrations: 200px minimum

Clear space: 1x cap height on all sides. No exceptions.

Approved colors:

- Primary: Nina Night on Dutch White
- Reversed: Dutch White on Nina Night
- Single color: Nina Cerulean on white — interactive contexts only

What never happens:

- Drop shadows on the wordmark
 - Wordmark directly on a busy photograph
 - Living N illustrations below 200px
 - Stretching or distorting the wordmark
 - Cursive "Nina" script as primary mark
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Component Defaults

Button: Dutch White ( #F5E3C1) on Nina Cerulean ( #007E95) | Border radius 4px | Padding 16px/32px | Inter 600 16px | Min touch target 44px

Links: Nina Cerulean ( #007E95) | Underline on hover only | Never color alone to indicate a link

Cards: Dutch White ( #F5E3C1) background | 1px Nina Slate border at 30% opacity | Border radius 8px | 24px padding | No shadow

Spacing: Base unit 8px. All values multiples of 8.

COMPONENT 3: WEBSITE WIREFRAMES

The Wireframe Principle

Every page has one job. Every page has one primary CTA:

"Try Nina — \$19/month. Free for NEU students."

Nothing on this site exists to inform, impress, or entertain. Everything exists to get a visitor to press that button.

Page 1 — Homepage

Primary job: Convert a first-time visitor into a user in under ten seconds.

Hero (above fold — no scrolling):

- Illustrated N — Paper N launch variant, large
- Headline (Inter 800): *Most brand tools tell you your work looks great.*
- Subhead (Inter 600): *Nina tells you what's wrong.*
- Body (Inter 400, 2 sentences): *Nina is an AI Creative Director with 35 years of real-world expertise — available 24/7, in any language, at a price that has never existed for this level of thinking.*
- CTA button: Try Nina

Below fold — three blocks:

1. Two-tile audience block: Students | Nonprofits. Real photograph, one sentence, micro-CTA each.
2. Three-step product explanation: Nina asks → Nina finds what's broken → You walk away with something real.
3. Social proof: One student story. One nonprofit story. Real names, real outcomes.

Exit risk: Visitor doesn't immediately understand who this is for. Mitigated by two-tile audience block.

Page 2 — About

Primary job: Build enough trust that a skeptical visitor becomes a convinced one.

Hero:

- Real photograph of Nina Harris — working, not posed
- Headline: *Nina Harris spent 35 years making brands matter. Now that expertise is available to anyone.*

- Two-paragraph origin story

Three blocks:

1. Nina Harris credentials — four specific facts, not a resume
 2. Nik Bear Brown — one paragraph, his photograph
 3. Humanitarians AI connection — one sentence, logo, link
-

Page 3 — How It Works

Primary job: Show the product experience clearly enough that a visitor knows what they're buying.

Five blocks — one per product layer:

1. "First, Nina figures out who you are." — Brand foundation
 2. "Then Nina finds your story." — Story arc workshop
 3. "Nina builds your story library." — Eight story types
 4. "Nina gives you a visual identity." — Color, type, logo, contrast checking
 5. "Nina hands you a brief your designer can build from." — Wireframes and style guide
-

Page 4 — For Students & Nonprofits

Primary job: Speak directly to each audience with enough specificity that each feels the site was built for them.

Two-column layout:

Left — Students:

- *Headline: You built real skills. Nina gives you the language to prove it.*
- Maya's story, three sentences
- Three specific outcomes
- Free for NEU students. \$19/month everyone else.

Right — Nonprofits:

- *Headline: Eleven years of real work. Nina finds the story that gets it funded*

- Headline: *Eleven years of real work. Nina finds the story that gets it funded.*
- Carmen's story, three sentences
- Three specific outcomes
- Nonprofit discount available

Bottom: INFO7375 connection — real students, real class, real outcomes.

Page 5 — Contact

Primary job: Remove every remaining obstacle.

Top: Two contact options — email and LinkedIn. No contact form.

FAQ — four questions only:

1. Is Nina really free for NEU students?
2. What does \$19/month include?
3. What nonprofit discount is available?
4. Who built Nina?

Bottom: Final CTA — *"Still reading? That means you have something worth building. Let's start."*

User Flow Narrative

A first-time visitor arrives after reading a Humanitarians AI Substack article.

Step 1: Hero lands. She reads the headline in three seconds. She recognizes herself.

Step 2: She sees herself. Two-tile block. Students. She clicks "This is for me →" She reads Maya's story. It sounds like hers.

Step 3: She understands what she's buying. How It Works. Five blocks. She reads the contrast checker note and thinks "I would never have known that."

Step 4: She checks the price. \$19/month. She has a .edu email. Free for NEU students. She presses the button.

Step 5: Conversion. She's in a Nina session. *"Before we design anything — before we write a single word of copy — I need to understand what you're building and who it's for."*

Total time from Substack article to Nina session: under four minutes.

Platform Comparison

Vercel v0 AI-generated interfaces from text prompts. Fast for developers who can read and edit code. Not appropriate for a non-developer on a real deadline. Eliminated for Nina's launch context.

Framer AI Visually sophisticated. Strong design control. Better for designers comfortable with a steeper learning curve. Better long-term option — not for a Friday deadline with no developer.

Wix Drag and drop. No code required. Wix AI generates a starting point from text. Adequate for an MVP. Less design precision than Framer. Good for students who need to launch this week.

Recommended for Nina: GoDaddy Website Builder The domain NinaHarris.co is already purchased through GoDaddy. The builder is included. For a non-developer launching on a real deadline with a domain already in place, GoDaddy removes one tool, one login, one monthly bill, and one technical decision.

Not the most sophisticated builder. Will not produce the most visually precise implementation. But it will produce a functional, mobile-responsive, five-page site this week.

Migration plan: Launch on GoDaddy. Prove the concept with the first 50 users. Migrate to Framer when the proof of concept is established.

Mobile Responsiveness

Homepage hero works on mobile before any other page is optimized. Headline, subhead, and CTA button visible without scrolling on 375px width (iPhone SE floor).

- Two-tile audience block stacks vertically on mobile
 - Navigation collapses to hamburger on mobile
 - CTA button minimum touch target: 44px
 - Body text minimum: 16px — never smaller
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MVP Launch Checklist

- ☐ All five pages built and linked
- ☐ Primary CTA working and linked to Nina session
- ☐ Mobile homepage tested at 375px

- ☐ All body text at minimum 16px
 - ☐ All color combinations checked — WCAG 2.1 AA
 - ☐ Real photographs — no stock
 - ☐ Bios accurate and approved
 - ☐ Humanitarians AI logo and link approved
 - ☐ FAQ answers accurate
 - ☐ Contact email active
 - ☐ NinaHarris.co pointed to the site
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APPENDIX: BRAND QUICK REFERENCE

Single-Minded Proposition

Nina is the Creative Director who was never available to the people who needed her most — until now.

Archetype Brief

Nina is a Sage with a Caregiver edge. It believes every person with something real to offer deserves the strategic foundation to make the world see it. It speaks to people doing meaningful work who can't yet explain why it matters. It will never flatten, flatter, or abandon someone mid-process.

Brand Kit Values

Primary: #002433 #363F44 #43545B #007E95 Secondary: #12B7BA #E7580B
#F5E3C1 #A42F33 Accent: #CE2D33 #FFAC12 #D54D04 #73838A Typeface: Inter
Variable — fonts.google.com/specimen/Inter Min body text: 16px | Min contrast: 4.5:1 body, 3:1 UI

Contrast Verification

WebAIM: webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker
Stark: Free Figma + Chrome plugin

This document is the brief. Everything that follows either honors this or explains why it doesn't.